

JANUARY 22

US Marines launch their last major offensive campaign of the Vietnam War, Operation Dewey Canyon.

FEBRUARY 22

In a renewed offensive, the Viet Cong and NVA launch attacks against US bases and cities across South Vietnam.

MARCH

An investigation begins into the March 1968 massacre at My Lai, triggered by letters from Vietnam veteran Ronald Ridenhour.

MARCH 17

President Nixon authorizes the secret bombing of enemy supply lines and bases in Cambodia.

APRIL 30 1969

American troop levels in Vietnam reach their peak at 543,400.

MAY 10–20

Costly fighting at Hamburger Hill in the A Shau Valley causes a political outcry in the United States, leading to a ban on further major offensive action by US ground troops.

JUNE 8

President Nixon announces the withdrawal of 25,000 troops from Vietnam.

AUGUST 14

Cambodian leader Norodom Sihanouk appoints pro-American General Lon Nol as his prime minister.

SEPTEMBER 2

Ho Chi Minh dies in Hanoi at the age of 79.

SEPTEMBER 6

Lieutenant William Calley is charged with the murder of Vietnamese civilians at My Lai.

OCTOBER 15

National Moratorium peace demonstrations take place across the United States.